ENGLAND, WALES AND NORTHERN IRELAND

Child under 4? You may get £9.30 a week for food.

It is called NHS Healthy Start. You get a prepaid card loaded with money for milk, fruit, vegetables and pulses — and free vitamins on top of it.

WHAT GOES ON THE CARD

£9.30

£4.65 a week from the 10th week of pregnancy. £9.30 a week for a child under 1. £4.65 a week for a child aged 1 to 4.

> Topped up every 4 weeks. You qualify through Universal Credit, or through Pension Credit that includes the child addition.

WHO DOES NOT GET IT

£408

Scotland does not have it: there it is Best Start Foods, with different amounts and different rules. And on Universal Credit, a family taking home more than £408 a month does not qualify.

> It has to be claimed — nothing arrives automatically — and it stops when the child turns 4.

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Not sure whether your household qualifies?

Message us and we will tell you what to check first. The application is online, at healthystart.nhs.uk.

0330 133 1886

General information. The full conditions and the application are at healthystart.nhs.uk.